The winter of AD 1498 was proving to be fortunate for Babur. His begs had got possession of many forts. A few were captured peacefully without dropping a single blood droplet, some were gained by fights while some by ruse and craft.

In the whole district, there was perhaps not a single village without its defences because of the Moghūls and the Aūzbegs.

On the other hand, Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā had turned suspicious of Sayyid Yusuf and his nephew on account of Babur's arrival. He dismissed them both towards Khurasan.

While the tug of war continued between the men of Babur and Ali Mīrzā, winter just passed off. Ali was instructed from Samarkand to take an army near Shiraz and Kabud. Babur had a force of merely 300 soldiers while powerful foes were on all sides. Babur felt heavily trapped. Fortune never sided with Babur historically, and so, he had genuine reasons for fear. His luck neither worked when he looked to re-capture Andijān, nor it was by his side when he looked to seize Samarkand. Babur helplessly had to come to terms with the setbacks and ride back to Pashaghar.

Khujand, an impoverished place, did not have much to take care of Babur's men. Babur mentions that they along with their families had been living for more than six months, and the locals had dedicated to do their best to serve them.

Babur again felt helpless and devastated. He did not know with what face would he return to his people. Neither did he know which home (Samarkand and Andijān) he would go nor was he aware of what he would gain for the stay in Khujand.

Anxious and loaded with uncertainty, Babur and his people went to the summer pastures of Aūrā-tīpā. They spent some days there in amazement given the position they were in, not knowing where to go or stay. Babur mentions that his head was whirling without any certain direction in mind.

Khwaja Abul Makaram came to see Babur on one of those days. He, like Babur and his people, was a wanderer driven from his home (Samarkand). He conveyed the best of courtesy by asking Babur about his and his troops' condition and the way forward. He was compassionate about Babur's state and recited the *Fatiha* for him before taking a leave.